

Chapter 163-1 Extra Chapter Five

Ning Fuyi soon learned what it was. Chu Qingqiu silently led her into the side hall, bent down and pulled out a wooden box from under the bed. When the box opened, dazzling red appeared before their eyes. Under the sunlight, the golden threads buried deep in the silk fabric flowed with radiant colors.

Ning Fuyi's eyes burned from the red color. She stared at it for a long while, then reached out to take it. The wind-like fabric slipped from her fingertips, and the dress quickly unfolded.

It was a wedding dress that looked like a mortal style, but with more ethereal elegance. It had fewer complicated details, with delicate golden threads hanging from the waist that would ripple like waves of wheat in the wind.

The hem was painted with the outlines of two birds using ink strokes, resembling mandarin ducks. However, for unknown reasons—perhaps lack of time or other reasons—silk embroidery had not been added yet.

Ning Fuyi's fingertips traced those earnest stitches, not knowing what to feel. So Su Mo had been confined to her room for half a month making their wedding dress.

Although the mandarin ducks hadn't been embroidered yet, there was crooked embroidery of characters beside them—not Su Mo's name, but Chu Qingqiu's.

Her eyes suddenly swelled with pain. She looked toward Chu Qingqiu.

"The fabric was something she begged Jiuying to get. It's cloud brocade¹ woven by the merfolk." Chu Qingqiu looked at the wedding dress and spoke, her voice no longer indifferent but carrying some hoarseness.

"She wasn't skilled at embroidery. These past few days, she was exhausted." Chu Qingqiu added, gently caressing the dress sleeves and holding them to her heart.

Su Mo was her, yet another version of her—the self she could hardly become.

A faint fragrance came from the sleeves.

Ning Fuyi said nothing. She lowered her head to wipe the moisture from her eyes, then smiled and spoke: "But the mandarin ducks aren't embroidered yet. What should we do?"

"I'll do it." Chu Qingqiu's face reddened again. She looked with difficulty at the fine stitches and took out an octagonal sewing box from the bedside.

Ning Fuyi watched her with a smile but said nothing. Then she took the needle and thread from her awkwardly positioned fingertips, skillfully threaded the needle, sat on the couch, and began embroidering stitch by stitch along the traces Su Mo had drawn.

Chu Qingqiu had thought she was joking, but watching the playful mandarin ducks gradually take shape, even she was shocked, staring at Ning Fuyi as if seeing her for the first time.

"What, surprised?" Ning Fuyi raised her head to wink at her between the flurrying movements of her fingers.

"I never knew you could do this." Chu Qingqiu sat down beside her, looking over her shoulder at the silver needle.

"I never said I couldn't." Ning Fuyi said, lowering her head to embroider seriously. When embroidering, the allure in her eyes and brows disappeared, making her look much more peaceful.

Chu Qingqiu watched for a while, then raised her hand, hesitantly reaching under Ning Fuyi's arm to circle her from behind, then resting her head on her shoulder, staying quietly.

"Ning Fuyi, I love you very much." She suddenly said.

Ning Fuyi was startled, then continued her movements with a smile, saying: "I know."

As soon as she finished speaking, the soft flesh at her waist was pinched. Ning Fuyi winced in pain while chuckling.

The room was quiet again for a while, then the woman's cold but bashful voice came from behind again.

"Yiyi, let's get married."